

Team 9 Heuristic Evaluation of Team 4

<https://www.figma.com/design/d2191VFE0X92S1NU8qXk5R/Team-4---Volunteer-App-Prototype?node-id=0-1&p=f&t=OjHCPrhgoS3oUrRa-0>

Heuristic Evaluation for team 4:

Issue: No clear indication that “Add to my itinerary” was successful

Severity: 3

Heuristic violated: Visibility of system status

Description: When a user taps “Add to my itinerary,” there is no feedback (animation, color change, or confirmation) showing the action was completed. This could leave users unsure if the action worked, leading to repeated or abandoned actions.

Issue: Navigation icons lack text labels

Severity: 2

Heuristic violated: Recognition rather than recall

Description: The bottom navigation bar only displays icons (Opportunities, Home, Messages) without textual labels visible by default. New users may struggle to identify the function of each icon, increasing cognitive load and reliance on memory.

Issue: “Join!” button does not clarify next steps

Severity: 3

Heuristic violated: Match between system and the real world

Description: The “Join!” button on the detailed view of the North Texas Food Bank does not explain what joining entails (e.g., volunteering, donating, or subscribing). Users may be hesitant to press the button due to uncertainty about its consequences.

Issue: Inviting friends lacks confirmation or progress feedback

Severity: 3

Heuristic violated: User control and freedom

Description: When inviting friends from the detailed view, there is no confirmation or undo option if a user invites the wrong person. Users cannot easily recover from a mistake or confirm that the action was processed successfully.

Issue: No error prevention for accidentally leaving a page

Severity: 2

Heuristic violated: Error prevention

Description: Users can inadvertently dismiss a page entirely by tapping on the navigation icons without warning or without having to confirm their action. This is a broader problem when they are in the middle of actions like joining an event or inviting friends, and when they realize the event is dismissed, all their progress is lost (if it is not saved automatically).

Issue: Overly detailed About section reduces scannability

Severity: 1

Heuristic violated: Aesthetic and minimalist design

Description: The About section is lengthy and text-heavy on the small mobile screen. Important information like “How to help” or “Volunteer steps” may be buried in long paragraphs, reducing efficiency for users who want quick actions.

Issue: No clear recovery instructions for failed actions

Severity: 3

Heuristic violated: Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors

Description: When users try to join an event or invite friends, which fails because of a network error, they do not receive any notification about what went wrong. A message noting the missing issue and instructions on how to resolve the issue or continue with the action.

Issue: No in-app help or tutorial

Severity: 2

Heuristic violated: Help and documentation

Description: The app lacks a help or tutorial section for new users. There are no quick tips or instructions for core actions like adding to the itinerary or inviting friends.

Issue: No shortcuts for frequent users

Severity: 2

Heuristic violated: Flexibility and efficiency of use

Description: Frequent users cannot save favorite volunteer organizations or quickly re-access recently joined events. Adding shortcuts or quick actions could improve efficiency.

Issue: Inconsistent use of icons for interaction

Severity: 2

Heuristic violated: Consistency and standards

Description: The home screen uses the heart icon to save things as favorites. However, the heart icon is not on the detail screen at all. The inconsistent use of the heart icon and its ability to save or favorite items may confuse users about how each part of the app allows them to save opportunities they are interested in.